



Refreshed Macbooks

Apple is reportedly planning to unveil three new laptops and refresh its entire MacBook line at upcoming WWDC. <http://digit.in/3WWDC>



Corsair T1 Race chair

Computer peripherals and hardware maker Corsair is launching its first gaming chair, T1 Race and it costs \$350. <http://digit.in/T1Race>



economic slowdown, so the foundation decided to help the teams by announcing the Terrestrial Milestone Prizes. In this, the foundation announced a total of \$6 million to be awarded through 2014 to teams achieving successful system demonstrations of Landing, Mobility and Imaging. Team Indus

was awarded a prize of \$1 million for the landing category, which was not only a huge help with funds at that point but also a strong validation of their efforts so far by an esteemed group of scientists.

Apart from this specific challenge, overall technical issues have been

faced and are being worked on by the team. For instance, the autonomous descent from orbit to surface is a critical juncture that could make or break the mission, as little is known about the lunar surface in terms of exact topography. Along with that, the radiation in outer space poses a serious threat to the craft and its cargo.

All these challenges are being worked on and overcome one by one by a team comprising of, among others, 20 ex-ISRO scientists, some of whom have worked on the iconic early space efforts of ISRO like the Aryabhata satellite. On the other hand, requirements for funds are also being worked on from multiple avenues.

FUNDS

There are mainly four different ways in which TeamIndus has acquired their funds so far:

- **Equity:** This has been their primary source of income, something that has kept their bills covered so far and will be doing so till the end of mission. Investors so far include Ratan Tata of Tata Group, Flipkart co-founders Sachin Bansal and Binny Bansal, Nandan Nilekani, co-founder Infosys, and many more.
- **Sponsorship:** With this mode, brands can get themselves to the moon – something that has been achieved by very few brands such as Hasselblad cameras and Omega watches. These will be premium payloads aboard the spacecraft.
- **Commercial payloads:** Apart from the previous section, the spacecraft will be capable of an overall 20kg payload (7.5kgs out of which is already dedicated to their own rover ECA) and some other quantity has been sold to Team Hakuto, another XPrize team. Team Indus is in advanced talks with other customers for the rest of the payload.
- **Backing campaigns:** There are certain campaigns ongoing on their website to get your name to the moon by inscribing it on a small sized aluminium object for a fee of ₹500.



Here's a look at the evolution of Rovers over the years